

Financial Modeling & Analytics

Instructor: Dr. Marcus Vance
Email: mvance@univ.edu
Office: Fincher Hall 302

Term: Summer/Fall 2026
Dates: May 27 – Sept 15, 2026
Office Hours: Mon / Wed 1:00 PM – 3:00 PM

COURSE DESCRIPTION

An introduction to building and analyzing dynamic financial models using Microsoft Excel. Topics include discounted cash flow (DCF) models, leveraged buyout (LBO) mechanics, capital budgeting, and advanced spreadsheet data management.

GRADING POLICY & WEIGHTS

Assessment Activity	Weight
Participation (Poll Everywhere & Attendance)	5%
Excel Financial Labs (Lowest 1 dropped)	15%
Weekly Modeling Homework (Lowest 2 dropped)	15%
Midterm Exams (2 Exams)	45%
Comprehensive Capstone Project & Final Exam	20%

COURSE SCHEDULE

Date / Session	Topics, Assignments & Deadlines
May 27 (Wed)	Course Introduction & Advanced Excel Keyboard Shortcuts
June 3 (Wed)	Module 1: Time Value of Money (TVM) Functions & Logic Trees
June 5 (Fri)	Lab 1 Due: Dynamic Financial Statements
June 10 (Wed)	Module 2: Cost of Capital (WACC) Modeling
June 17 (Wed)	Homework 1 Due / Module 2 Capital Budgeting
June 24 (Wed)	MIDTERM EXAM 1 (Modules 1–2)
July 1 (Wed)	Module 3: Forecasting Revenue Drivers & Operating Assumptions
July 8 (Wed)	Module 3: Debt Schedules & Interest Circularity

Date / Session	Topics, Assignments & Deadlines
July 10 (Fri)	Lab 2 Due: 3-Statement Model Integration
July 15 (Wed)	Module 4: Valuation Methodologies (Comps vs. Precedents)
July 22 (Wed)	Homework 2 Due / Module 4: Discounted Cash Flow (DCF) Mechanics
July 29 (Wed)	MIDTERM EXAM 2 (Modules 3–4)
August 5 (Wed)	Module 5: Sensitivity & Scenario Analysis (Data Tables)
August 12 (Wed)	Module 5: Introduction to M&A and LBO Modeling
August 14 (Fri)	Lab 3 Due: LBO Transaction Summary
August 19 (Wed)	Module 6: Monte Carlo Simulations in Wealth Management
August 26 (Wed)	Homework 3 Due / Case Study Reviews
September 2 (Wed)	Final Project Presentations & Group Evaluations
September 9 (Wed)	Comprehensive Final Review
September 15 (Tue)	COMPREHENSIVE FINAL EXAM (8:00 AM – 11:00 AM)